# Experiment 9
# Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-in Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

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## Title
Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-in Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator - Loan Application System.

## Aim
To explore the built-in analytics, interactive dashboard charts, and report display options of the Loan Application System in Zoho Creator, and to check the availability of AI-assisted (Zia) features in the application and its editor.

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## Objective
- To observe the KPI cards, charts, and reports displayed on the application dashboard.
- To study the interactive behavior of the pie chart and the column chart.
- To identify the built-in display formats available for a report.
- To check the Design and Workflow areas of the application editor for Zia / AI-assisted options.

## Software / Tools Required
- Zoho Creator (web-based low-code application development platform)
- Loan Application System created in Zoho Creator
- Web browser with an active internet connection
- Zoho account with access to the application and its editor

# Introduction / Theory

## AI-Assisted Features in Zoho Creator

AI-assisted features in a low-code platform are intended to help users build applications and understand their data with less manual effort. At a conceptual level, such features may assist with tasks such as generating insights from stored data, answering questions about data, or suggesting elements of an application. The availability of these features depends on the Zoho Creator edition, the plan of the account, and the interface version in use.

## Zia

Zia is the artificial-intelligence assistant of the Zoho ecosystem. Conceptually, Zia provides AI-driven capabilities, such as data insights and assistance in working with application data, within Zoho products. Whether and where Zia options appear in Zoho Creator depends on the account and plan.

## Built-in Analytics and Dashboards

Zoho Creator provides built-in analytics through pages and dashboards, which present application data visually without external tools. A dashboard combines several components on one page so that the status of the application can be understood at a glance. The following components are commonly used:

| Component | Purpose |
|---|---|
| **KPI cards** | Display a single key figure, such as a total or a count of records in a particular status. |
| **Charts** | Represent data graphically, for example pie charts for proportional distribution and column charts for comparison between categories. |
| **Reports** | Present records of a form in a structured manner, with columns for the fields of the form. |
| **Interactive visualizations** | Respond to user actions such as hovering, which displays the exact value represented by a chart segment or bar. |

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## Report Display Formats

A report in Zoho Creator can be shown in more than one display format through the Show As option. Different formats present the same records in different ways, for instance as a list, on a calendar, along a timeline, in a spreadsheet layout, or as a Kanban board, so that users can choose the format that suits the task.

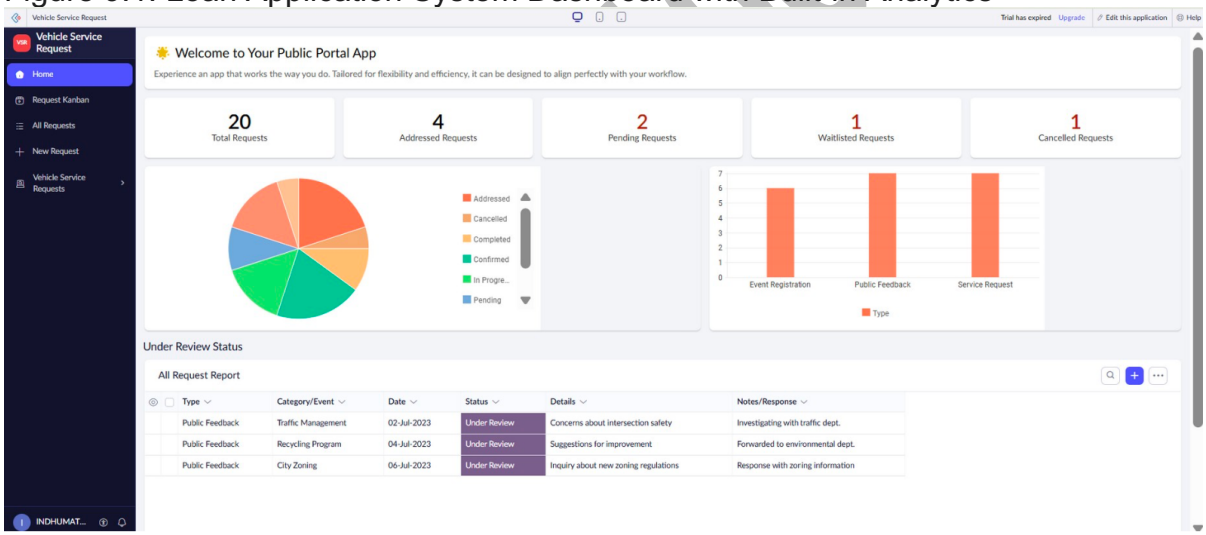
# Procedure

1. Open Zoho Creator and sign in. The home page lists the available applications.

2. Open the **Loan Application System** application and select **Access this application** to open it in its live (application) view.

3. Observe the dashboard (Home page). It contains the KPI cards, a pie chart, a column chart, an Under Review Status section, and the **All Application Report**.

Figure 9.1: Loan Application System Dashboard with Built-in Analytics




4. Examine the KPI cards and record the values displayed:

    - **Total Applications:** 20
    - **Approved Applications:** 4
    - **Pending Applications:** 2
    - **Waitlisted Applications:** 1
    - **Cancelled Applications:** 1

5. Examine the pie chart, which shows the distribution of loan applications by status. Its legend lists the status categories: *Approved*, *Cancelled*, *Completed*, *Confirmed*, *Under Review*, and *Pending*.

6. Place the pointer over a segment of the pie chart. A tooltip is displayed showing: Status - Under Review: 3.

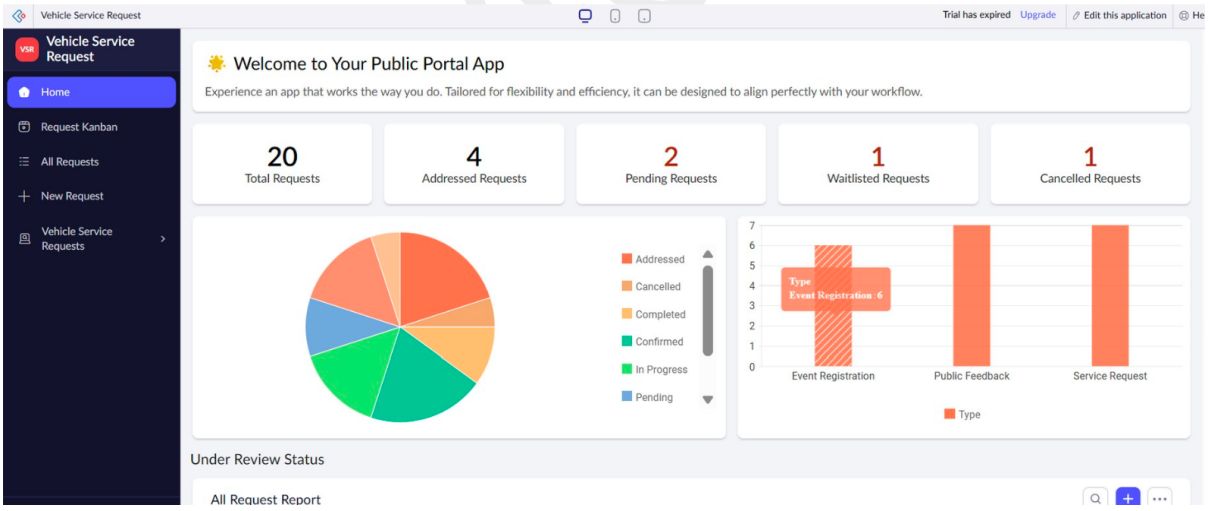
Figure 9.2: Interactive Pie Chart Showing Loan Application Status




7. Examine the column chart, which shows the number of applications for each loan type (*Personal Loan*, *Home Loan*, and *Vehicle Loan*).

8. Place the pointer over a bar of the column chart. A tooltip is displayed showing: Type - Home Loan: 6.

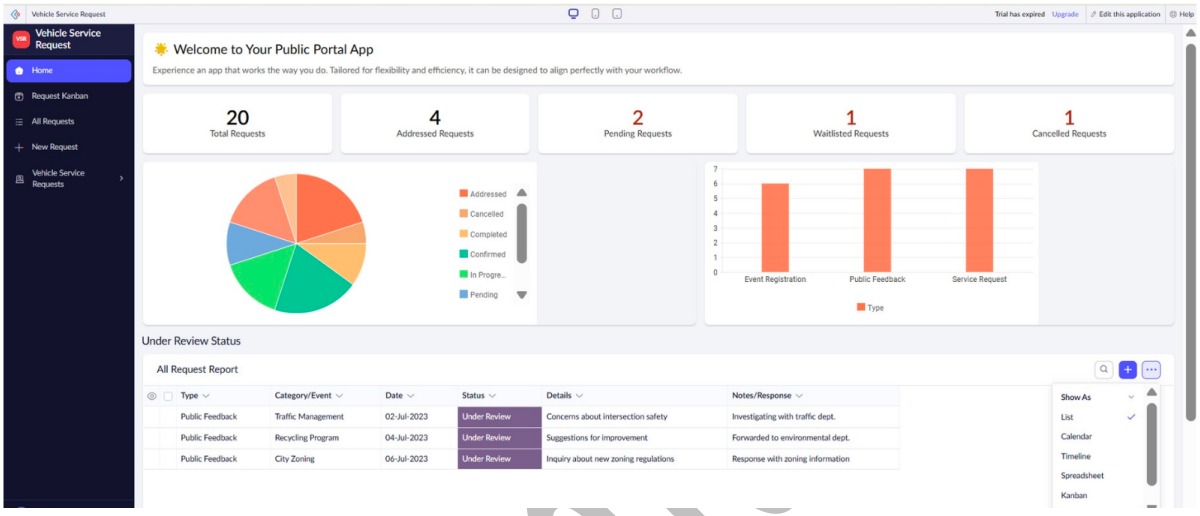
Figure 9.3: Interactive Column Chart Showing Loan Application Type



9. Scroll to the **All Application Report** and open the options menu (three dots) at the top-right corner of the report.

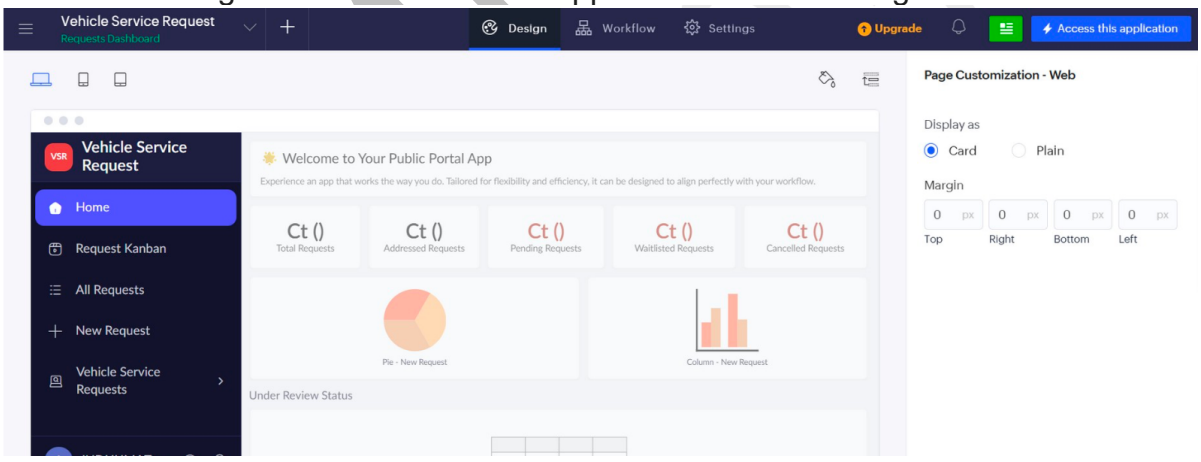
10. Open the **Show As** menu and record the options available: **List**, **Calendar**, **Timeline**, **Spreadsheet**, **Kanban**, and **Import**. The menu is only viewed; no report view is changed or saved.

Figure 9.4: Built-in Report Views in the All Application Report




11. Select **Edit this application** to open the application editor, and check the **Design** area for any Zia, Analytics, or AI-specific option.

Figure 9.5: Zoho Creator Application Editor - Design Area




12. Check the **Workflow** section of the editor. Workflow and form-related options are available, but no Zia / AI analytics feature is present.

13. Note that the account displays *"Trial has expired"* with an **Upgrade** option, and record that Zia / AI-assisted functionality was not available in the current account / interface.

# Dashboard Analytics

## KPI Card Summary

The KPI cards on the dashboard displayed the following values:

| KPI | Value |
|---|---|
| **Total Applications** | 20 |
| **Approved Applications** | 4 |
| **Pending Applications** | 2 |
| **Waitlisted Applications** | 1 |
| **Cancelled Applications** | 1 |

## All Application Report Sample

The **All Application Report** on the dashboard is organized under the columns: **Type**, **Category/Branch**, **Date**, **Status**, **Details**, and **Notes/Response**. The records visible in the report under the Under Review Status section are listed below:

| Type | Category/Branch | Date | Status | Details |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Home Loan** | Verification Desk | 02-Jul-2026 | Under Review | Property document appraisal pending |
| **Personal Loan** | Credit Division | 04-Jul-2026 | Under Review | Income verification in progress |
| **Vehicle Loan** | Auto Desk | 06-Jul-2026 | Under Review | Vehicle hypothecation check |

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# Interactive Chart Analysis

The charts on the dashboard respond to the pointer and display exact values on hovering:

| Chart | Hover Result | Interpretation |
|---|---|---|
| **Pie chart (Status distribution)** | Status - Under Review: 3 | Three loan applications are currently in the Under Review status. |
| **Column chart (Loan type)** | Type - Home Loan: 6 | Six loan applications belong to the Home Loan type. |

This demonstrates that the dashboard charts provide interactive data details: the exact count behind a segment or bar can be read directly from the chart hover state instead of being estimated visually.

# Built-in Report Views

The **Show As** menu of the **All Application Report** listed the options below. The menu was only opened to explore the options; none of the views was applied, modified, or saved. The **List** option carried a check mark, indicating that it was the display format in active use.

| Option | General Description | Observation |
|---|---|---|
| **List** | Shows records as rows in a tabular list with a column for each field. | Listed; currently selected |
| **Calendar** | Places records on a calendar according to a date field. | Listed in menu |
| **Timeline** | Arranges records chronologically along a timeline. | Listed in menu |
| **Spreadsheet** | Presents records in a grid layout similar to a spreadsheet. | Listed in menu |
| **Kanban** | Displays records as cards grouped in columns, typically by status. | Listed in menu |
| **Import** | Provides the option to bring data into the report's form from an external file. | Listed in menu |

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# Zia / AI-Assisted Feature Exploration

The application and its editor were checked for Zia / AI-assisted functionality:

- **Design area:** Inspected through the application editor (Figure 9.5). No Zia, Analytics, or AI-specific option was visible.
- **Workflow section:** Inspected. It contained workflow and form-related options, but no Zia / AI analytics feature was available.
- **Account status:** The account displayed *"Trial has expired"* with an **Upgrade** option.

Therefore, Zia / AI-assisted functionality was not available in the current account / interface. Zia was not used, configured, or demonstrated in this experiment, and no AI-generated insights were obtained. The analytics demonstrated in this experiment are the built-in dashboard and reporting features of the application.

# Result

The following were successfully carried out in the Loan Application System:

- The dashboard KPI values (**Total 20**, **Approved 4**, **Pending 2**, **Waitlisted 1**, **Cancelled 1**) were observed.
- The interactive pie chart (Status - Under Review: 3) and column chart (Type - Home Loan: 6) were explored.
- The built-in report display options (**List**, **Calendar**, **Timeline**, **Spreadsheet**, **Kanban**, and **Import**) were identified in the Show As menu.
- The Design and Workflow areas were checked for Zia / AI-assisted features; however, no such option was available in the current account/interface because the trial had expired. Hence, Zia was not used in this experiment.

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# Conclusion

The experiment demonstrated the built-in analytics of Zoho Creator through the Loan Application System. KPI cards summarize key figures, interactive charts reveal exact values on hovering, and the Show As menu offers several formats for viewing report data. These features help in monitoring loan applications without external analytical tools. The Zia / AI-assisted functionality could not be explored because it was not available in the current account / interface, where the trial had expired. The practical work therefore covered the built-in dashboard analytics, interactive charts, and report-view options.